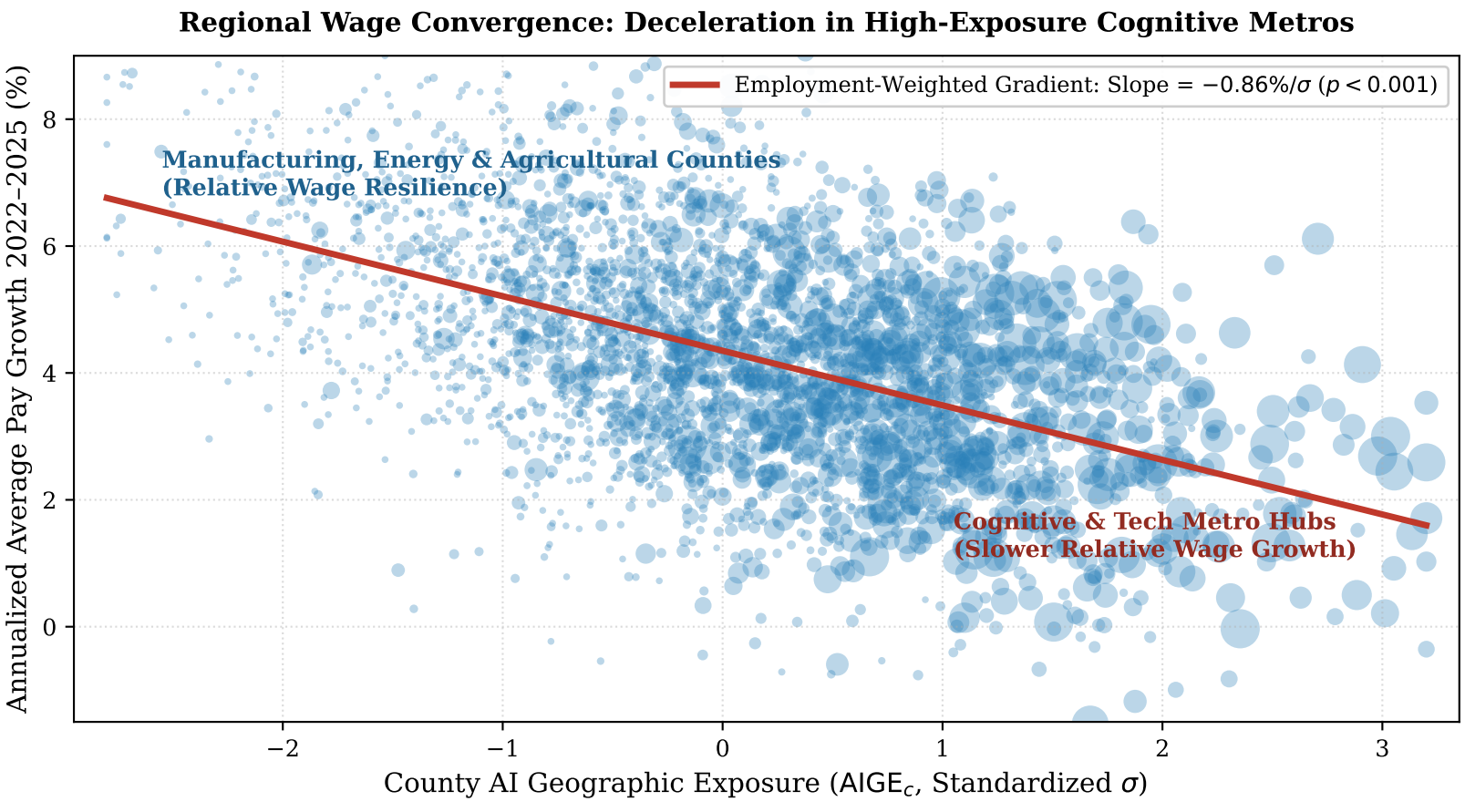

Regional Wage Convergence: Deceleration in High-Exposure Cognitive Metros
Employment-Weighted Gradient: Slope = −0.86%/σ (p < 0.001)
Manufacturing, Energy & Agricultural Counties
(Relative Wage Resilience)
Cognitive & Tech Metro Hubs
(Slower Relative Wage Growth)
Annualized Average Pay Growth 2022–2025 (%)
County AI Geographic Exposure (AIGE$_c$, Standardized σ)
8
6
4
2
0
−2
−1
0
1
2
3